

# SENTENCE, ELEMENTS AND STRUCTURES

*Building clearer, stronger sentences for IELTS & PTE Writing and Reading*

**An inductive, discovery-based class**

## WARM-UP

# Finished or Unfinished?

React 👍 if it feels like a complete, finished thought. React 🤔 if something feels missing.

1. The heavy rain last night.
2. Flooded the low-lying streets.
3. Students and teachers arrived early.
4. Because the exam started at nine.
5. Waited outside the gate for twenty minutes.
6. The manager approved the request.
7. After the long meeting on Tuesday.
8. Our team finished the project and celebrated.

## Green Roofs in Modern Cities

In many big cities, architects and city planners are turning old rooftops into gardens. They put plants, small bushes, and trees there. These roof gardens are called “green roofs”. They can hold rainwater and make the city cooler. Cities and companies are now building more green roofs. This is good for many reasons, not just for looks. A green roof can save energy, clean the air, and give a home to birds and insects.

Cities like London, New York, and Singapore, in the last ten years, have made hundreds of green roofs. People who live or work near these gardens often feel happier and more relaxed. But building a green roof is not easy. The roof must be strong because soil and water are heavy. So, engineers and architects plan it together very carefully. Green roofs cost a lot of money at first. But many building owners think it is a good choice. Green roofs make the building last longer. They also help save money on heating and cooling.

## EXPOSURE / INPUT

1. Green roofs **cost** a lot of money at first.
2. But many building owners **think** it is a good choice.
3. Green roofs **make** the building last longer.
4. They also **help** to save money on heating and cooling.

1. **Cost** (Base form) **Think**
2. **Costed** (Past form) **Thought**
3. **Costed** (Past participle) **Thought**
4. **Costs** (Present form) **Thinks**
5. **Costing** (Present participle) **Thinking**
6. **To cost** (Infinitive) **To think**

## NOTICING

# Reading Like a Detective

*Look at the same passage again — this time for pattern, not meaning.*



**Bold, blue**

the SUBJECT (who or which)



Underlined, green

the PREDICATE (the verb + the rest)



*Italic, orange*

a PHRASE worth noticing

## NOTICING

### Spot the Pattern

*In many big cities,* **architects and city planners** are turning old rooftops into gardens.

**Cities and companies** are now building more green roofs.

**A green roof** can save energy, clean the air, and give a home to birds and insects.

## NOTICING

### Spot the Pattern (continued)

Cities like London, New York, and Singapore, *in the last ten years*, have made hundreds of green roofs.

People *who live or work near these gardens* often feel happier and more relaxed.

The roof must be strong because soil and water are heavy.

## In Pairs — Look Closely

1. How many people or things are doing the action? Is that one word, or a group joined by “and”?
2. How many verbs are joined together in the predicate? What word joins them?
3. Can you find a short phrase (2–4 words, no verb of its own) that adds extra time, place, or manner detail?
4. If your sentence is long, what is its shortest version — just subject + main verb?

### Discovery Worksheet — Write Your Own Rule

1. What TWO things does every sentence contain? “A complete sentence must have \_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_.”
2. Compare “architects and urban planners” with “a green roof.” What's the difference? When is a subject “simple” vs. “compound”?
3. Look at a predicate with two or three joined verbs. What word links them? Write a rule for a “compound predicate.”
4. What job does a phrase do — naming a thing, describing an action, or telling us where/when/how?
5. What is your strategy for finding the “core” of a long sentence?

## The Rule, in Our Own Words

- 1 Every sentence needs a SUBJECT (who / which) and a PREDICATE (the verb + the rest).
- 2 SIMPLE = one doer / one verb idea. COMPOUND = two or more, joined by and / or / but.
- 3 A PHRASE has no subject-verb pair of its own — it's a noun, verb, or prepositional group doing one job.
- 4 To break down a long sentence: find the main verb → ask who / what does it → that's the core.

## **Exercise A — Find the Subject & Predicate**

1. The heavy morning traffic delayed hundreds of passengers.
2. Farmers and exporters welcomed the new trade policy.
3. The committee reviewed the proposal and rejected it.
4. Solar panels on the roof reduce electricity bills significantly.
5. Doctors, nurses, and volunteers worked through the night.

## Exercise A — Answers

| Subject                         | Predicate                              |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| The heavy morning traffic       | delayed hundreds of commuters          |
| Farmers and exporters           | welcomed the new trade policy          |
| The committee                   | reviewed the proposal and rejected it  |
| Solar panels on the roof        | reduce electricity bills significantly |
| Doctors, nurses, and volunteers | worked through the night               |

## Exercise B — Combine the Sentences

*Join each pair into ONE sentence using a compound subject or predicate.*

1. The government raised fuel prices. The opposition criticised the decision.
2. Tourists visit the beach in summer. Local fishermen visit the beach in summer.
3. The company launched a new app. The company hired 200 engineers.
4. Rainfall increased this year. River levels rose sharply this year.
5. Students submitted their essays online. Teachers submitted feedback online.

## Exercise B — Answers

1. The government raised fuel prices, and the opposition criticised the decision.
2. Tourists and local fishermen visit the beach in summer.
3. The company launched a new app and hired 200 engineers.
4. Rainfall increased and river levels rose sharply this year.
5. Students and teachers submitted their essays and feedback online.

## Exercise C — Find & Fix the Error

1. Because the exam was difficult.
2. My father a doctor in Dhaka.
3. The manager and his team is preparing the report.
4. The price of vegetables have increased this month.
5. The new policy is helpful, students are happy about it, teachers agree too.

## Exercise C — Answers

1. Because the exam was difficult, many students left early. *[fragment]*
2. My father is a doctor in Dhaka. *[missing verb “is”]*
3. The manager and his team are preparing the report. *[agreement]*
4. The price of vegetables has increased this month. *[agreement]*
5. The new policy is helpful, so students and teachers are happy about it. *[run-on]*

## Newsroom Practice (Speaking)

*You're junior editors. Practice this trainee reporter's choppy draft so it reads fluently.*

The city built a new park. The city built it last year. Families visit on weekends. Children visit on weekends. The park has a lake. The park has a jogging track. The council maintains the park. Volunteers maintain the park. The park needs more shade. The park needs more seating. Local businesses donated benches. Local businesses donated trees. The project cost a lot of money. The project improved the neighbourhood a lot.

## Your Speaking May Include:

- ✓ One fluent paragraph (5–8 sentences)
- ✓ At least 2 compound subjects (joined with and / or / but)
- ✓ At least 2 compound predicates
- ✓ At least 2 prepositional phrases (time, place, or manner)
- ✓ No fragments, no run-ons — every sentence complete

## SPEAKING

*“How has your hometown changed in the last ten years? Who is responsible for these changes?”*

*Try to use at least one compound subject or compound predicate in your answer.*

## Quick Recap

In one sentence — what does every English sentence need?

What's the difference between simple and compound?

What's your strategy for breaking down a long sentence?

## Before You Go...

*Type ONE original sentence of your own — about anything — that contains a compound subject OR a compound predicate.*

## Analyse This Passage

1. Underline every subject and label it simple or compound.
2. Circle every predicate and label it simple or compound.
3. Bracket 3 phrases and label each: noun / verb / prepositional.

Coastal wetlands, including mangrove forests and salt marshes, protect shorelines from storm surges and absorb large amounts of carbon dioxide. Governments and conservation groups increasingly invest in restoring these habitats because degraded wetlands release stored carbon back into the atmosphere. Local communities and fishing cooperatives often support restoration projects, since healthy wetlands sustain fish populations and tourism income alike.

## Write 5 Original Sentences

*Topic: environmental problems in your city or town (for an IELTS Task 2-style paragraph).*

- ✓ At least 2 compound subjects
- ✓ At least 2 compound predicates
- ✓ At least 1 prepositional phrase
- ✓ No fragments and no run-ons